CREATE FORMULAS WITH FUNCTIONS

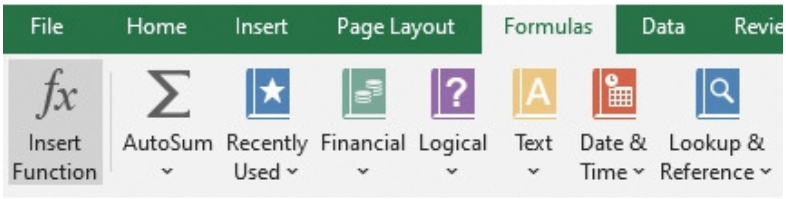
Excel functions are essentially predefined formulas that automate calculations. Formulas in Excel always start with an equal sign (=) followed by the function name and any necessary arguments enclosed in parentheses. Excel provides two methods for creating formulas that utilize functions:

- Guided Procedure
- Typing the formula into a cell or formula bar

GUIDED PROCEDURE

Function arguments are beneficial for users who are not yet familiar with or do not readily recall all the primary functions in Excel. The steps to utilize function arguments are as follows:

1. Start the Guided Procedure
   Choose the desired function from one of the available categories or click the *Insert Function* button located on the *Formulas tab* in the *Function Library Group*. You should then start the guided procedure:



   Alternatively, click on *Insert Function* located to the left of the formula bar. You can also select a function directly from the menu which appears when you enter the *equal sign (=)* in a cell. By Excel's default, the drop-down menu shows only the 10 most recently used functions. To view the entire list, you must select the *Other Functions...* item...